described as well-mannered and made a living by taking online orders for his father's shop and delivering goods to customers. Riyaz, a near-illiterate steel fabricator, was known to be loud and rough in the locality where he kept shifting houses often after defaulting on the rent. But Iqbal Bhai, who runs a small biryani shop next to Riyaz's latest residence, says he hardly noticed the man or his wife.

Muslims in Udaipur are not particularly orthodox, and it is unusual to see a woman in a burqa. So here too, there was nothing that stuck out from the ordinary. But inspector general of police, Udaipur range, Praful Kumar says radicalisation has to be looked at more deeply. "The frequency of Gaus's conversations with his two handlers in Pakistan increased considerably in the two weeks before the murder. Before we handed over the accused to the NIA, we learnt about the two recently being asked to do something big to become the poster boys of the Tehreek-e-Labbaik Pakistan (TLP)." TLP is an extremist Islamist organisation that was earlier banned in Pakistan. The role of social media in instigating the killers is also being looked into.

Investigations so far indicate that on his Pakistan trip Gaus visited the Karachi-based Daawat-e-Islami–a non-profit with no terror links and known for its Islamic educational institutions across the world—and was probably recruited as a good contact in India. He has been in active touch with someone from the TLP, and at least one other person in Pakistan, who may have been Gaus' handlers there. One of them has been identified as a caretaker at the Dawat-e-Islami headquarters and the other one is a preacher. Agencies are ascertaining whether, in the 45 days he spent in Pakistan, he had gone to places other than Karachi (for which he was issued the visa) and if that country's intelligence agency, the Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI), is complicit in the matter.

Indians going to Pakistan on religious visits is not an unusual thing. By the same token, Indian agencies habitually screen such travellers, though a source in the Intelligence Bureau said it is not possible to scan everyone, especially if the name does not pop up on their radar.

But what has sparked a major controversy is the presence of Riyaz at a number of events organised by the BJP



GRAVE TRAGEDY Murder victim Kanhaiya Lal's son Tarun with his father's ashes in front of their house in Udaipur, July 4

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

THE ACCUSED WERE REPORTEDLY TOLD TO "DO SOMETHING BIG" TO BECOME THE POSTER BOYS OF THE EXTREMIST OUTFIT, TEHREEK-E-LABBAIK PAKISTAN

